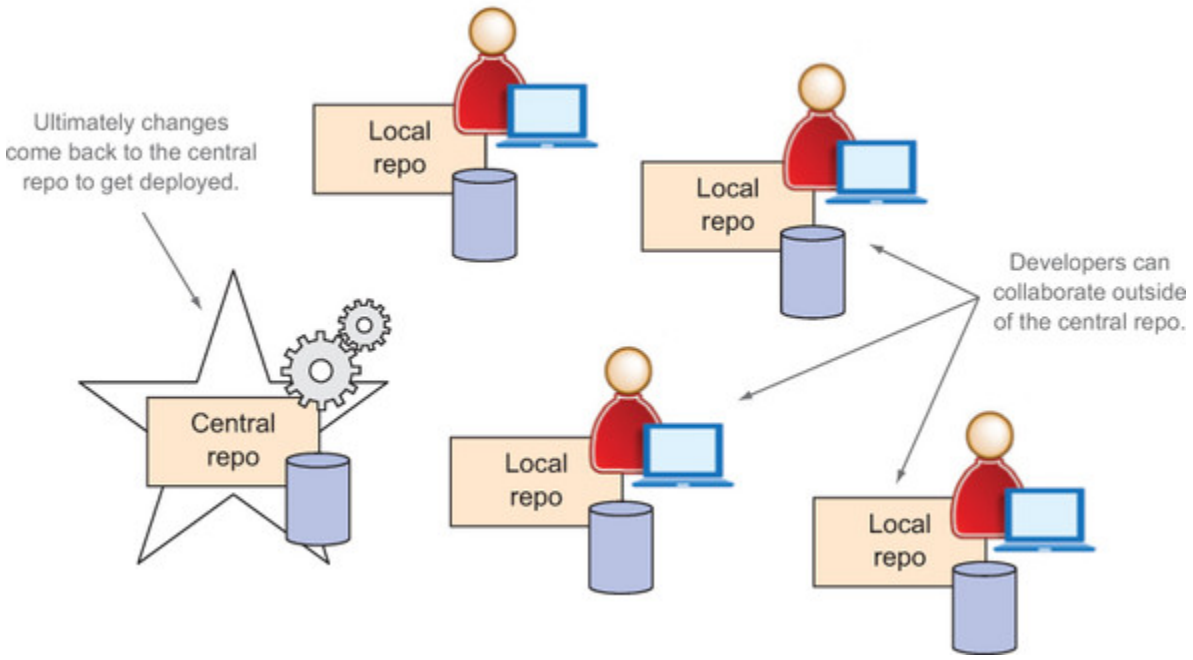


Note in figure 4.4 that there's still a central repo where the master history is stored and the final product is deployed from.

SCM systems have two primary focal points:

- Saving the history of everything that happens to the code
- Fostering great collaboration

Centralized SCM systems have all the history in one place: the central repo. DVCSs save the history of changes no matter where they happen and as a result have a much richer set of data available around code changes. In addition, DVCSs typically have RESTful APIs, which make getting that data and reporting on it with familiar constructs plug and play at this point.

From the perspective of someone who wants to get as much data about your team's process as possible, it's much better to use a DVCS because you can tell a lot more about how the team is working, how much collaboration is happening, and where in your source code changes are happening.

A common practice in teams that use DVCSs is the idea of a pull request. When a developer has a change or a set of changes that they want to merge